

## melo

Amsterdam is renowned for its incredible live music scene. In the Jordane area of the city is one of the best blues clubs in the world, the incredibly authentic Mellow Mellow. I caught up with the owner, Jor.

Travel Radio Australia, I'm in Amsterdam and we're in the oldest blues bar in Amsterdam and I have the owner Jor here and owner, welcome to the program. Hello, great to see you. Now Jor, this place is very special, it's a real hub for musicians and music fans from around the world, right? Yes, when you see the pictures you can see who play here, real famous guys.

Yeah, tell us about a few of those people who actually appeared here. Really? Just a whole range of superstars coming in. Yeah, just a ton of people and plus all the regular people here in Amsterdam who are musicians come here and play.

You have people like Franklin from T-Set who plays here on a regular basis and with that song, My Bellamy, back from the 60s and everything. And tell us, how did the place get started? You started it yourself, tell us a bit about it. I started in 1984, I play music.

There was a friend of mine here at the club behind here, a smaller club. I started there with the sessions. When he stopped, he told me, it's not for you.

And I was thinking, yeah, I'm a free guy, why not? And that was the beginning. Wow, and it's just taken off from there and the Blues fans, if you're coming to Amsterdam, this is the place, Mellow Mellow. Can you give us the address here if people want to find it? When you were cuckoos, there's enough.

So we always have to look up Mellow Mellow and it's M-E-L-O-E, right? That's it. Yeah. And I've been here a number of times myself and the music is just fantastic.

It's a tiny cover charge of five euro to get in and see the bands, but some bands charge a bit more. Then it is how famous, the bent, how more you pay. Exactly.

And they have their own cover charges. But on a normal night here, it's usually five or maybe 10 max. That's great.

And no, it's a very special building here. And do you have any interesting stories about someone coming here and playing out of the blue who just turns up and says, I can play in there. Someone super famous.

There was with Petit Schmidt. She come here. She came ten years long in Amsterdam.

And then after she came here in the Mellow Mellow, she's sitting in the corner. She was looking to the bench here. One time they call me.

Petit Schmidt, she will play in the Mellow Mellow. Okay. She comes on stage, put her on the monitor.

As I say, the sound is better than GBGBs and it smells better than GBGBs. And now we go rocking. Wow, that is incredible.

That's incredible. And you're in what? You're 82 now. You've been doing this for how long? In March.

81 now. You're only a baby now. And I know that when they told you all those years ago that you could run a club and you might be able to meet some women.

And you're still hoping that that might happen, right? It's been a little while, but never mind. This is Big Frankie in the background here and he's super famous here in Amsterdam as well. Can I have a chat with Big Frankie as well? Yeah, sure.

Big Frankie, you're a music icon here in Amsterdam and you've been coming here for many, many years. Yeah, I'm coming here from the beginning actually in 1984. Yeah, it's a long time ago.

And you moved a few doors on because in 1991, I think. He had to close down for four years and then he was on the road with his own band. But luckily, there was a place free and he could continue Malo Malo.

And that made a lot of artists happy because you gives a platform to many, many artists who are famous now. And we had the first stage experience in Malo Malo. That's amazing.

Yeah. And you're part of the Rolling Stones entourage. You regularly tour with them around the world.

And I believe that the Stones have even played some people from the Stones, some artists from the Stones have already played. Yes, yes. We had Blondie Chaplin here.

He was nine years backing vocalist in the Rolling Stones. Bernard Fowler was here, I guess. And Mick Taylor.

Bill Hyman. Mick Taylor. I wasn't here.

He was sitting there. And some people, I don't know. Are you a musician? Yes.

Are you a guitar player? No, I'm a drummer. I live here in the King Street. So he was pretending, right? Yeah.

He was a lookalike. Oh, he's pretending. He wasn't real.

He wasn't real. But he will shut up. I'm sitting there.

He didn't want that attention. Still, it's amazing. You will be in the beginning of March 82.

He's still working behind this bar for four nights. And that is amazing. And the people love you.

They come here and play. And even young people come now to do that thing. And the first experience with music, you have YAM sessions with the great Franklin Magit and Sam and more people here who do the sessions.

So everybody can bring their instruments. And on, I think, Tuesday and Thursday, they can do a session here. But anyway, you can look it up on the site.

It's Mellow Mellow on the Limehouse, 163 in Amsterdam. It's a great place to be. So I hope you all come here when you visit Amsterdam.

Yes. So it's Mellow Mellow dot N L. Right. Online.

Merleau. Merleau. And how do you spell that? M-A-L-O-E.

Yes. Merleau. Yes.

Yes. Oh, there it is. It's on the stage there.

You can't. So it's M-A-L-O-E and then M-E-L-O. Punt N-L dot N-L.

Yeah. That's fantastic. Well, thank you so much for being on the program.

It's a really historic place. And if you are coming to Amsterdam, this is the place to hang out. If you're into blues music, it's absolutely fantastic.

As I say, low cover charge. You can come in and just have a wonderful time. Have a beer and listen to some tremendous music.

And thanks for being on the program. OK. Thanks.

And can you say hello to all of our people? Can you say hello in Dutch to all of our people in Australia? Because we have a lot of Dutch people living there. Hello. I'm from Australia, and I'm here with you today.

I'm from Australia, and I'm here with M-A-L-O-E. And you call me here and say, what's your name? M-A-L-O-E. What's your name? Yeah, what's your name? M-A-L-O-E.

Yeah, yeah, yeah. And Big Frankie, thank you very much. Big Frankie, the music legend.

Just ask anyone in Amsterdam about Big Frankie, and he's like one of the unofficial mayors here.

Now, just come to Malamello and check it out. It's a great place.

And it's an honor to meet Jörz Herpersal, who's running the place since 1984. Wow. Incredible.

Thanks for being on the program, guys. OK. Thank you.

Well, we certainly got around the world again for this episode of Travel Radio Australia. Join us next time for more destinations and information from around the planet. And until next time, safe travels.